

DUBAI IS IN the midst of a sustained real estate upswing, driven by high-net-worth migration, significant global capital inflows, and the combined impact of speculation, investment demand, and end-user buying. The result is a market that continues to expand quickly. Within this landscape, Indian-origin real estate developers are scaling their presence across the UAE. One of the fastest-rising names is BNW Developments. Led by Chairman and Founder Ankur Aggarwal, the company's last four to five years have seen sharp growth and a rapidly growing profile—further amplified by actor Vivek Oberoi's association with the venture. *Business Today* met Aggarwal in his Dubai office to understand what is powering BNW's ambitions, and how it is positioning itself in a competitive market. Edited excerpts:



Why did you get into Dubai and its real estate sector?

Dubai is obvious because of multiple factors. A lot of people are choosing the city as their second home, as it is the safest country in the world. In real estate, particularly post Covid, Dubai has performed the best in the world—



DUBAI REAL ESTATE: BOOM OR BUBBLE?

Ankur Aggarwal, Chairman & Founder, BNW Developments, on what's fueling Dubai's surge, RAK's casino-led upside, his India plans and more

prices have gone up two to three times just in five years. It is going up one way, and the government is putting in a lot of effort to make it continue. In my opinion, it will not stop as people want to come here, un-

like in the past when it was hard to convince the Western world to come to Dubai.



Is there a bubble or is this structurally different?

It is very simple. The UAE government, and not just Dubai, has taken a lot of initiatives to welcome new population into the country. The current population of Dubai is 3.8 million and given